

The report

Present findings and recommend action

Word count ~250 or ~400 words	Register Formal and neutral	Title Subject line + section headings	Structure Header + sections
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STRUCTURE AND LAYOUT

Date: – [date]

From: – [your name / role]

Subject: – [clear, descriptive title]

Introduction – ~50–80 words – state purpose and data source

Section + heading – ~50–80 words – main point 1, under its own heading

Section + heading – ~50–80 words – main point 2, under its own heading

Conclusion / Recommendations – ~50–80 words – summarise + suggest action

DO'S AND DON'TS

DO

- Present and analyse facts; save your own view for the recommendations
- Be neutral and keep to the point
- Use the passive voice where appropriate
- Include specific data when referencing surveys/statistics – you may invent realistic figures
- End with clear recommendations or suggestions
- Make the layout clear: headings and short sections
- Use a range of linking words

DON'T

- Don't give personal opinions in the main body
- Don't repeat information across sections
- Don't write anything that isn't relevant
- Don't forget the Date / From / Subject header
- Don't forget section headings
- Don't use emotional or informal language

WEAKER VS. STRONGER

WEAKER

I really think the school canteen is terrible and nobody likes it.

STRONGER

Key findings: 68 per cent of the 120 students surveyed rated the canteen food as poor or very poor.

Why it matters. A report stays factual and presents its evidence under meaningful headings. Personal outbursts cost you marks because the register is wrong.

KEY TIP

You can recognise a report at a glance because of its headings. Give every section a meaningful heading (for example "Key findings"). You do not need to number them.

MODEL TEXT

Survey Results – Student Stress Levels (~250 words · Formal register)

Structure Content Language Text-specific

Date: 15 March 2026

From: Anna Gruber, Student Council

Subject: Survey Results – Student Stress Levels¹

Introduction²

This report presents the findings of a survey on stress levels conducted among 85 students in years 5 and 6. The aim is to identify the main causes of stress and suggest possible measures.³ The survey was carried out anonymously⁴ over a two-week period in February and consisted of ten questions on workload, sleep and support services.

Key Findings

The majority of respondents (72%)⁵ reported feeling stressed on a regular basis. Exams and homework deadlines were identified as⁶ the primary sources of pressure. In addition,⁷ 45% mentioned sleep problems connected to school-related anxiety. Only 18% were aware of the school's existing counselling services. When asked about the timing of stress, students pointed clearly to the weeks before exams. Notably, girls reported higher stress levels than boys⁸, although both groups named similar causes.

Recommendations⁹

On the basis of these findings,¹⁰ I would recommend¹¹ introducing a weekly "no-homework day" and promoting the counselling service through posters and assemblies. It would also be advisable to¹² schedule exams more evenly across the term to reduce pressure peaks. Finally, teachers could be encouraged to coordinate test dates through a shared online calendar so that deadlines do not pile up in the same week.

Conclusion¹³

In summary, stress is widespread among younger students and is closely linked to exams and homework. If these recommendations are put into practice¹⁴, the school could noticeably improve both student wellbeing and academic results.

WHAT THE EXAMINER NOTICES IN THIS MODEL

The numbers match the marked passages in the model text.

1. **Header – Date, From, Subject all required:** "Date: 15 March 2026 From: Anna Gruber, Student Council Subject: Survey Results – Student Stress Levels"
2. **Section heading:** "Introduction"
3. **States purpose of report:** "The aim is to identify the main causes of stress and suggest possible measures."
4. **Passive – objective method:** "carried out anonymously"
5. **Report language – cite data precisely:** "The majority of respondents (72%)"
6. **Passive voice – objective tone:** "were identified as"
7. **B2 linking word:** "In addition,"
8. **Precise reporting of data:** "Notably, girls reported higher stress levels than boys"
9. **Every section gets its own heading:** "Recommendations"
10. **Linking word for report conclusions:** "On the basis of these findings,"
11. **Recommendation – required in every report:** "I would recommend"
12. **Formal suggestion phrase:** "It would also be advisable to"
13. **Optional final section:** "Conclusion"
14. **Conditional – formal close:** "If these recommendations are put into practice"

USEFUL PHRASES

Introduction

- As requested, I have prepared a report on...
- The aim of this report is to...
- This report examines/compares...
- The data was collected through...

Presenting data

- Twenty per cent of the people asked...
- The majority of respondents...
- One in five stated that...
- It is generally felt that...
- A large proportion of those interviewed...

Conclusion / Recommendations

- On the basis of these findings,...
- I would therefore recommend/suggest that...
- It would seem that... is the best option.
- In view of this, one can recommend...
- It would also be advisable to...

More online. On the website this text type also has a second model text ("Report on the use of the school library", ~250 words · formal) and a realistic borderline text with notes on where it loses marks: matura.bernhardgmeiner.com/report/